

# Gal Bitton

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Last Updated: July 26, 2026

## Appointment

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| <b>The Hebrew University of Jerusalem</b><br><i>Lecturer (Assistant Professor), Department of International Relations</i>                                   | 2027 -    |
| <b>Harvard University</b><br><i>Postdoctoral Fellow, Mossavar Rahmani Center for Business and Government (M-RCBG), Harvard Kennedy School of Government</i> | 2026-2027 |
| <b>Harvard University</b><br><i>Postdoctoral Fellow, Weatherhead Scholars Program</i>                                                                       | 2025-2026 |

## Education

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| <b>Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>Ph.D. in Political Science</i><br>Dissertation: “From Barriers to Bridges: The Cultural Roots of International Financial Engagement” | 2025 |
| <b>Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>M.A., Magna cum Laude, Political Science</i>                                                                                         | 2021 |
| <b>Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>B.A., Political Science</i>                                                                                                          | 2018 |

## Fellowships

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>POLPOP III, Tel Aviv University</b><br><i>Scholar Fellow</i>                                                                                         | 2025-2027 |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS), Harvard University</b><br><i>Scholar Fellow</i>                                                | 2025-2027 |
| <b>Center for American Political Studies (CAPS), Harvard University</b><br><i>Scholar Fellow</i>                                                        | 2025-2027 |
| <b>The Azrieli Graduate Studies Fellowship</b><br><i>Pre-doctoral Fellow</i>                                                                            | 2022-2025 |
| • Only about 1.6% of social sciences PhD students are selected each year                                                                                |           |
| <b>The Center for the Study of the United States (CSUS), Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>Pre-doctoral Fellow - Partnership with the Fulbright Program</i> | 2022-2023 |
| <b>The Edmond J. Safra Center for Ethics, Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>Pre-doctoral Fellow</i>                                                         | 2021-2022 |
| <b>Tel-Aviv University</b><br><i>Doctoral Fellow</i>                                                                                                    | 2019-2025 |

## Research Interests

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(International) political economy; Foreign policy analysis; Behavioral economics; Comparative politics; Political attitudes & behavior; Survey design and experimental methods.

## Peer-Reviewed Publications

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- “Shifting Sands? The Impact of Conflict Displacement on Voting Patterns.” **Political Studies** (*Forthcoming*).  
[Pre-registration](#)
- “Rally Around the Winner – A Two-Wave Panel Survey on the Impact of the U.S. Elections on Foreign Policy Stances.” **International Journal of Public Opinion Research** (2025) (with Eyal Rubinson).

## Research in Preparation

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### Under Review

- “How Does Cultural Identity Shape Global Financial Engagements?” (*Revise & Resubmit, Business and Politics*).
- “The Premium of Familiarity: Experimental Evidence on Financial Interactions Between Foreigners.” (*Review of International Political Economy*).  
[Pre-registration](#)
- “The Welfare Consequences of Political Rivalry in a Polarized Era.” (with Claretta Treger) (*Revise & Resubmit, Journal of European Public Policy*).  
[Pre-registration](#)  
[Pre-print](#)
- “When Does War Exposure Become Political Violence? Distress, Cognitive Flexibility, and Domestic Violent Intentions.” (with Daphna Canetti, Sivan Hirsch-Hoefer, and Tal Shaanan) (*British Journal of Political Science*).
- “Assembling Security Consensus: Political Violence, Ideology, and Support for State Surveillance.” (with Daphna Canetti, Giulia Dal Bello, Julia Elad-Strenger, and Sivan Hirsch-Hoefer) (*Journal of Peace Research*).
- “Backsliding Divides, War Unites: Threat, Ideology, and Political Trust Across Internal and External Crises in Israel.” (with Keren LG Snider) (*Democratization*).

### Working Papers

- “Are findings of research on International Organizations generalizable?” (with Tal Sadeh and Bernhard Reinsberg)
- “Who Deserves a Safety Net? Labour-Market Dualization and Moral Heuristics.” (with Gianluca Busilacchi).
- “Blame Attribution and Blame Shifting to International Organizations.” (with Tal Sadeh, Yuval Hirshorn, and Benjamin Daßler).  
[Pre-registration](#)
- “Do and When Adverse Banking Conditions Affect Public Support for the Government?” (with Tal Sadeh, and Yuval Hirshorn).
- “Terror, Interstate Conflict, and the Politics of Restraint: How Different Forms of Violence Shape Foreign Policy Attitudes” (with Keren LG Snider, Amit Cohen and Daphna Canetti).
- “Optimistic Today, Pessimistic Tomorrow: How Do Elites View Public Opinion on International Aid?” (with Lior Sheffer and Eran Amsalem)  
[Pre-registration](#)

## Work in Progress

- “The Effect of Targeted Corrections of High Salience Misperceptions on Partisan Threat Attribution, Antidemocratic Attitudes, and Support for Political Violence” (with Sam Fuller).
- “Elite Cues and Public Support for Security Alliances: A Survey Experiment” (with Eyal Rubinson).
- “Do Voters Reward Eurosceptic Governments?” (with Tal Sadeh)  
[Pre-registration](#)

## Research Experience

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|                                                                              |                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>The Institute for Liberty &amp; Responsibility at Reichman University</b> | <i>2022-2025</i>       |
| <i>Research Assistant</i>                                                    | Head: Dr. Amnon Cavari |
| <b>“How Politicians Evaluate Public Opinion” (POLPOP II)</b>                 | <i>2022-2023</i>       |
| <i>Research Assistant</i>                                                    |                        |
| ERC-funded research team; PIs: Lior Sheffer (TAU) and Eran Amsalem (HUJI)    |                        |

## Grants

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|                                                                                                                                        |                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Tel Aviv University Presidential Scholarship for Post Doctoral Studies for Women</b>                                            | <i>2024-2026</i>                                 |
|                                                                                                                                        | (\$50,000)                                       |
| <b>Research grant from the Institute for Freedom and Responsibility at Reichman University</b>                                         | <i>2024</i>                                      |
|                                                                                                                                        | (NIS 8,000)                                      |
| <b>The Azrieli Graduate Studies Fellowship</b>                                                                                         | <i>2022-2026</i>                                 |
|                                                                                                                                        | (NIS 366,000)                                    |
| • Only about 1.6% of social sciences PhD students are selected each year                                                               |                                                  |
| <b>The Center for the Study of the United States (CSUS) in Partnership with the Fulbright Program</b>                                  | <i>2022-2023</i>                                 |
|                                                                                                                                        | (NIS 3,000)                                      |
| <b>Research grant from the Institute for Freedom and Responsibility at Reichman University</b>                                         | <i>2022</i>                                      |
|                                                                                                                                        | (NIS 10,000) - Collaborated with Claretta Treger |
| <b>Research Grant for outstanding graduate students, Faculty of Social Sciences, Tel-Aviv University</b>                               | <i>2022</i>                                      |
|                                                                                                                                        | (NIS 10,000)                                     |
| <b>Doctoral Fellowship Program at The Edmond J. Safra Center for Ethics, Tel Aviv University</b>                                       | <i>2021-2022</i>                                 |
|                                                                                                                                        | (\$20,500)                                       |
| <b>The Richard and Rhoda Goldman Fellowship Fund Scholarship for the Enhancement of the Quality of Governance, Tel Aviv University</b> | <i>2021</i>                                      |
|                                                                                                                                        | (\$5,000)                                        |

## Awards & Honorable Mentions

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|                                                                                                                 |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Harrell Rodgers Travel Scholarship, Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)                                | 2025        |
|                                                                                                                 | (\$500)     |
| • Awarded to only 4% of applicants                                                                              |             |
| Travel Grant, The Society for Political Methodology                                                             | 2024        |
|                                                                                                                 | (\$1,000)   |
| Best Presentation Award, The 4 <sup>th</sup> Haifa International Social Sciences Workshop for Graduate Students | 2022        |
|                                                                                                                 | (\$700)     |
| Best Submission from Pre-tenure Scholars by the Joint IPE Conference of the DVPW, ÖGPW and SVPW                 | 2022        |
| Tel Aviv University Graduate Students Excellence Award & Scholarship                                            | 2022        |
|                                                                                                                 | (NIS 7,000) |
| Reichman University Teaching Assistant Excellence Award & Scholarship                                           | 2021        |
|                                                                                                                 | (NIS 2,000) |
| Dean's Honor List, B.A.                                                                                         | 2017-2018   |
|                                                                                                                 | (NIS 2,000) |

## Conference Presentations

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|                                                                                   |                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| American Political Science Association (APSA)                                     | 2023, 2024 <sup>*</sup> , 2025 |
| Canadian Political Science Association (CPSA)                                     | 2024 <sup>*</sup>              |
| Political Economy of Aid and International Organization (PEAIO)                   | 2025                           |
| Political Economy of International Organization (PEIO)                            | 2023, 2024, 2025               |
| <b>Democracy and Political Violence (DPV) Mini-Conference (Organizer)</b>         |                                |
| • First Annual Meeting, Harvard University                                        | 2026                           |
| (De)polarisation in Values, Attitudes and Beliefs Workshop, King's College London | 2024                           |
| DVPW–ÖGPW–SVPW Joint International Political Economy Conference                   | 2022                           |
| ESPAnet Virtual Workshop                                                          | 2024                           |
| European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)                                 | 2022                           |
| European Union Studies Association (EUSA)                                         | 2023 <sup>*</sup> , 2025       |
| Foreign Aid and Political Gains Workshop, University of Haifa                     | 2023                           |
| Graduate Student International Political Economy (GSIPE)                          |                                |
| • Workshop                                                                        | 2021                           |
| • Mini-Conference: Qualitative & Mixed Methods Research in IPE                    | 2021                           |
| Haifa International Social Sciences Workshop for Graduate Students (HSSC)         | 2022                           |
| IASEI–NYU Workshop                                                                | 2024                           |
| International Conference of Europeanists                                          | 2023 <sup>*</sup>              |

## International Political Economy Society (IPES)

- Annual Meeting 2021, 2025
- Virtual IPES 2025

## International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP)

- Annual Meeting 2026
- Virtual Academy 2024\*

## International Studies Association (ISA)

2023, 2024

## Israeli Association for International Studies (IAIS)

- Annual Meeting 2022, 2023, 2026
- Research Colloquium for Ph.D. Students in International Studies 2022

## Israeli Political Science Association (ISPSA)

2022

## Jerusalem–Tel Aviv Forum for Empirical Studies in Politics

2022

## Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)

2022–2025, 2026\*

## Political Studies Association (PSA) Early Career Network

2024

## Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science

2024, 2025

## Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth)

- Annual Meeting 2022, 2024
- PolMeth Europe 2022

## Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)

2022, 2023\*, 2026

## Western Political Science Association (WPSA)

2025\*

\* Accepted; cancelled participation.

## Invited Talks

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The Policy, Elections, and Representation Lab (PEARL) Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy, University of Toronto March 13, 2023  
“How Does Cultural Identity Shape Financial Policies?”

Panelist; “Europe: a crisis in light of energy”, Model UN, TAU January 9, 2023

Department of Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz October 28, 2022  
Lecture: “The Premium of Familiarity”

## Research Stays & Visits

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Visiting doctoral student at the University of Konstanz 2022  
One month (October) Host: Prof. Gerald Schneider

## Teaching

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### Lecturer

## The Hebrew University, Department of International Relations

- *The International Financial System and Economic Crises* (graduate) 2027–
- *The Microfoundations of International Political Economy* (graduate) 2027–

## Teaching Assistant

### Reichman University, Lauder School of Government

- *Advanced Research Methods* (graduate) 2020–2024
- *Intermediate Research Methods* (graduate) 2020–2023
- *Empirical Research* (undergraduate) 2020–2023

### Tel-Aviv University, School of Political Science

- *Europe in a Crisis* (graduate) 2019–2024
- *Political Economy in the Global Age* (graduate) 2019–2022
- *International Political Economy* (graduate) 2019–2022
- *Introduction to Writing and Research in Political Science* (undergraduate) 2019–2021
- *Introduction to International Relations and Strategy* (undergraduate) 2019–2021

## Service and Other Academic Activities

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- **Reviewer:** Comparative Political Studies; European Journal of International Relations; International Studies Quarterly; Journal of Regulation & Governance.
- **Chair & Discussant:** GSIPE Mini-Conference; Political Economy of International Organization (PEIO); The IASEI-NYU Workshop; The 19<sup>th</sup> European Union Studies Association (EUSA).
- **Statistical Consultant:** Provides statistical and analytical assistance for students.
- **Workshops:** Programming and data analysis workshop using STATA: Beginner to Advanced.
- **Mentor:** Project mentor of “Why do I need democracy now?”, for undergraduate students. The Unit for Social Involvement at Tel Aviv University (2023-2024).

## Technical Reports

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- Bitton, G. “A Reflection of Society: Israeli Public Attitudes Toward Political Violence” The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2024. Available [online](#).
- Bitton, G. “Does the Israeli Public Want an Anti-Democratic Leader?” The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available [online](#).
- Bitton, G. “Does the Israeli Public Support the Override Clause?” The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available [online](#).
- Bitton, G. “Jewish Identity or Democratic Values - What Do Israelis Prefer?” The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2023. Available [online](#).
- Bitton, G. “Trust Crisis in the Israeli Public?” The Institute for Liberty & Responsibility at Reichman, 2022. Available [online](#).

## Interviews & Publications in Popular Media

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- DemocratTV: “Do Israelis Prefer Less Democratic Leadership Since October 7?” Host journalist: Attila Shumpelvi. Interview available [Online](#).
- Bitton, G. “Believe in Choice - What do Israelis think about abortion?” The Liberal, 22.9.2022. Available [online](#).

## Additional Academic Training

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- The 2026 ISPP Academy in University of Newcastle, United Kingdom.
- The Third IO Editorial Café workshop during the 2023 annual meeting of the International Studies Association in Montreal.
- Online oTree course at the Nuffield Centre for Experimental Social Sciences, at the University of Oxford (Instructor: Tommaso Batistoni).
- Data Science Bootcamp: a computational tools and programming for text analysis workshop, at Tel Aviv University (Instructor: Koby Mike).

## Research Skills

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- **Languages:** R, Python, STATA, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Markdown.
- **Software:** RStudio, oTree, Git/GitHub, STATA, JMP, SPSS, and Qualtrics.

## Languages

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- Hebrew (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic).

## Community Engagement

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### **Mentor in the “Sawa” program at Tel Aviv University**

2021-2024

*Providing academic, personal, and emotional assistance to Israeli-Arab students*

### **Research assistant in The Social Guard**

2017-2019

*A non-governmental organization monitoring Knesset activities to promote social justice and increase civic engagement*

## Non-Academic Certificates

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- First Aid, 28-hour training (Awarded by Malar, Israel)
- 200-hour training for yoga teachers (registered with the Yoga Alliance)